
CHURN IS DEAD

The Credibility Debt Audit

A diagnostic tool for CS teams

Before you rename a single role, map what your customers actually experience across every post-sales touchpoint. This audit tells you where you're borrowing credibility you haven't earned — and where the balance comes due at renewal.

Scoring: Rate each item 1-5. 1 = not happening, 5 = embedded in operations.

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SECTION 1

1. The Commission Question

A number the customer can smell defeats any title. If the customer feels the commercial pull in the room, no rebrand hides it — you've just widened the gap between what you call the role and what it does.

Criteria	What Good Looks Like	What Bad Looks Like
Role-level comp transparency	Each customer-facing role is clearly commercial-with-an-honest-name OR technical-with-no-commercial-pull	A 'strategic advisor' title sits on top of a hidden expansion quota
The minute-forty test	A check-in can run 60 minutes without steering toward seats, licenses, or renewal timing	Every 'strategic' conversation finds its way to a seat count by minute forty
Customer-perceived incentive	Customers can articulate what your role is paid on and it matches what you say you do	Customers manage the person carefully because they sense a quota with their logo on it
Title-to-incentive alignment	The title accurately labels the commercial reality of the job	An engineer's title covers a salesperson's number — the widest gap possible

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
Role comp is honestly named: commercial roles carry commercial titles, technical roles carry no commercial pull	1-5
Customer-facing conversations survive without drifting to a commercial ask	1-5
Customers experience the role as its stated identity, not as a disguised commercial motion	1-5

Your Score: ____ / 5

SECTION 2

2. The Deliverable Test

A borrowed title without a borrowed deliverable is an empty label. Palantir's FDE described a shippable outcome. Ask the hard version: what fraction of your 'value' is shippable work versus narration of value the product already produced.

Criteria	What Good Looks Like	What Bad Looks Like
Shippable outcome	The role produces a working technical thing the customer couldn't get from sales	The role narrates value the product delivered on its own
Sales-differentiation	The person delivers something a skilled AE demonstrably cannot	The 'value delivered' is a deck sales could have produced
Technical vs. narration ratio	The majority of claimed value is shippable technical work	The shippable fraction is small; the rest is relationship management describing existing outcomes
Title-deliverable match	The title describes the deliverable, not the aspiration	The engineer title is borrowed with none of the engineer's output

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
The role produces outcomes sales cannot replicate	1-5
A meaningful fraction of claimed value is shippable technical work, not narration	1-5
Every customer-facing title is backed by a matching deliverable	1-5

Your Score: ____ / 5

SECTION 3

3. The Handoff Scar

Every place the customer got passed from 'trusted' to 'sold to' is where the debt was borrowed. The scar is relational, not informational — automating goal reconstruction doesn't repair the trust that snapped when the customer felt the handoff.

Criteria	What Good Looks Like	What Bad Looks Like
Handoff mapping	Every sales-to-onboarding, onboarding-to-CSM, CSM-to-renewals, renewals-to-sales handoff is documented	Handoffs happen invisibly and no one owns the tone shift
Tone continuity	The customer experiences consistent advocacy across every transition	Tone shifts from advocacy to ask at each pass, and the customer remembers every one
Trust vs. information transfer	Relationship trust is preserved, not just goal data reconstructed	Goals get re-documented while the snapped trust goes unrepaired
Reactive load	Proactive advisory motion runs across the full book, not just the top three accounts	80% of the calendar is reactive; strategy happens for three accounts on a good month
Retention-correlated work	CSM activity is aligned to work that actually moves retention	Over 50% of activity has zero correlation with retention — absorbed from support, sales, and product

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
Every handoff is mapped and owned, with tone continuity across transitions	1-5
Handoffs preserve relational trust, not just transfer information	1-5
CSM time is spent on retention-correlated work, not absorbed cross-functional load	1-5

Your Score: ____ / 5

SECTION 4

4. The Repayment Motion

You earn a new title by shipping the technical outcome first, then letting the customer name what you are. Deliver first, get named second, monetise third. Invert that order and you spend credibility you haven't earned — the balance comes due at renewal.

Criteria	What Good Looks Like	What Bad Looks Like
Deliver-first sequence	The role ships a technical outcome before claiming any new title	The title is announced in a reorg memo before any new outcome exists
Customer naming	The customer names what the role is, based on what was delivered	The company assigns the label and hopes the customer agrees
Monetization timing	Commercial value is captured only after delivery and naming	The role monetizes before earning trust, exposing the gap at renewal
Rename honesty	Rebrands describe a real structural change already in place	The rename refinances the debt at a worse rate, disguising rather than closing it

Score This Section

Criteria	Score
Technical outcomes are shipped before any title claim is made	1-5
Customers name the role based on delivered value, not marketing	1-5
Commercial capture follows delivery and naming, never precedes it	1-5

Your Score: ____ / 5

CHURN IS DEAD

Your Scorecard

Dimension	Your Score	Max
1. 1. The Commission Question	_____	5
2. 2. The Deliverable Test	_____	5
3. 3. The Handoff Scar	_____	5
4. 4. The Repayment Motion	_____	5
TOTAL	_____	20

Total Score	Assessment	What It Means
16-20	Uncuttable	Embedded, measurable, strategically irreplaceable.
12-15	Defensible	Solid but gaps remain. Focus on lowest dimension.
8-11	Vulnerable	Real risk ahead. Treat as urgent.
4-7	Critical	Cannot survive scrutiny. Major changes needed.

What to do next: Take your lowest-scoring section and build a 30-day action plan. One at a time. Then share this with leadership -- not to ask permission, but to show you know where the gaps are.

A rename is what you reach for when you can't afford the thing the rename is describing.

-- Kuber

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